

KNIGHTS TEMPLAR

Historical Order, Masonic Templary, and Modern Neo-Templar Organizations

MASTER RESEARCH REPORT

Compiled from the research record developed in this project, with cross-reference to medieval scholarship, papal records, modern legal registrations, official Masonic histories, specialist Masonic research bodies, periodicals, and digital archives.

Prepared September 2026

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1. Executive Summary

This report consolidates the full research developed in this project concerning the medieval Knights Templar, the trial and suppression of the Order, the Chinon Parchment, the emergence of modern Templar revival organizations, Masonic Templary, and the earliest documentary evidence for Templar-themed Masonic degrees. It also records corrections made during the research process where later evidence superseded earlier provisional conclusions.

The central historical boundary is 22 March 1312. The medieval Order of the Temple was suppressed by Pope Clement V through Vox in excelso. The Chinon proceedings of August 1308 materially affect how the heresy proceedings should be understood: senior Templar leaders, including Grand Master Jacques de Molay, were absolved from ecclesiastical censures and reconciled to the Church. The Chinon Parchment, however, did not create a successor organization, rescind the later suppression, transfer Templar corporate identity to another body, or establish a modern line of Grand Masters.

Accordingly, no modern organization identified in this research has demonstrated juridical continuity from the medieval Order merely by appeal to the Chinon Parchment. Modern organizations are therefore best separated into: (1) the historical medieval Order and legally documented property successors; (2) Masonic Templary, a distinct eighteenth-century and later Christian Masonic chivalric tradition; and (3) neo-Templar or pseudo-Templar organizations, including revivalist, derivative, independent Christian, Catholic-restoration, esoteric, and direct-succession-claiming bodies.

Masonic Templary must be kept separate from neo-Templar succession claims. The Grand Encampment of Knights Templar, U.S.A. does not claim that fugitive medieval Templars infiltrated operative masons or that modern Freemasonry is the corporate continuation of the medieval Temple. Its public mission is to provide Christian Freemasons an opportunity to extend their Masonic journey through a chivalric experience. Masonic scholars including Arthur Edward Waite, Wallace McLeod, John Hamill, Henry Wilson Coil, S. Brent Morris, Arturo de Hoyos, and Alain Bernheim support an evidence-based distinction between medieval Templar history and later Masonic Templar ritual.

The earliest securely documented Anglo-American conferral of the recognizable Masonic Knight Templar / Order of the Temple remains the conferral on Captain William Davis in Boston on 28 August 1769, followed by Paul Revere on 11 December 1769 and Joseph Warren on 14 May 1770. Continental Templar-themed Masonic degrees appear earlier, with evidence clustering around the 1750s, including early Elu/Kadosh material and the Strict Observance.

2. Scope, Methodology, and Terminology

2.1 Scope

The project began as a global inventory of pseudo-military knightly organizations claiming Templar identity and developed into a broader institutional-history study. The report therefore covers both organizations that claim actual succession and organizations that openly identify themselves as modern revivals, spiritual heirs, chivalric associations, Masonic bodies, or Catholic Templar-inspired associations.

2.2 Evidentiary method

- Primary medieval sources and papal acts are distinguished from later interpretation.
- Legal incorporation or civil registration is distinguished from a group's claimed historical founding date.
- An organization's own lineage statement is treated as a claim unless independently corroborated.
- Current institutional affiliation is distinguished from historical provenance. A modern body can be non-Masonic today while descending through a nineteenth- or twentieth-century lineage that involved Freemasons.
- Masonic ritual borrowing, homage, or symbolic use is not treated as proof of institutional descent.
- For early Masonic Templary, dated minutes, warrants, manuscript rituals, contemporary periodicals, and official proceedings outrank later retrospective assertions.
- The term neo-Templar is preferred as a neutral scholarly umbrella term. Pseudo-Templar is retained when discussing the user-requested classification, but it should not automatically imply fraud.

2.3 Core terminology

Term	Working definition
Historical Order	The medieval Poor Fellow-Soldiers of Christ and of the Temple of Solomon, c.1119-1312.
Property successor	An institution receiving former Templar property or functions without becoming the Templar corporation itself.
Masonic Templary	A Christian Masonic chivalric system using Templar and crusading imagery as moral, ritual, and devotional symbolism.
Neo-Templar	A modern organization reviving, reconstructing, commemorating, spiritually inheriting, or claiming succession from Templar identity.
Claimed survival	A modern or early-modern claim that the medieval Order continued secretly after 1312; such a claim requires independent documentation.
Documented revival	A modern body with a verifiable modern foundation date, regardless of older lineage claims.
Institutional affiliation	Formal organizational control, charter relationship, canonical status, or membership dependence.
Historical provenance	The genealogy of a movement, including founders, precursor bodies, and prior affiliations.

3. The Historical Order of the Temple, c.1095-1314

This section integrates the crusading context, formation and ecclesiastical recognition of the Order, the role of St. Bernard of Clairvaux, papal privileges, the principal military campaigns and castles, the loss of the Latin East, and the royal, inquisitorial, episcopal, papal, and secular proceedings that culminated in suppression. Malcolm Charles Barber's *The New Knighthood* and *The Trial of the Templars* provide the principal modern scholarly framework. The chronology distinguishes foundation, formal Church recognition, theological definition, papal privilege, prosecution, and suppression rather than treating them as a single event.

3.1 Integrated chronology: First Crusade to suppression and final executions

Date	Place	Event and significance
1095	Clermont, France	Pope Urban II calls the First Crusade at the Council of Clermont. This creates the crusading movement and political environment from which the military orders later emerge. Urban II did not found or institute the Knights Templar. Major figures of the First Crusade would include Godfrey of Bouillon, Raymond IV of Toulouse, Bohemond of Taranto, Tancred, and Baldwin of Boulogne.
1096-1099	Asia Minor, Syria, Palestine	First Crusade. Western crusading armies move toward Jerusalem and establish the military-political setting in which the future Templars will operate.
15 July 1099	Jerusalem	Jerusalem is captured by the First Crusade. The resulting Latin Christian states - the Kingdom of Jerusalem, County of Edessa, Principality of Antioch, and County of Tripoli - face chronic shortages of manpower and must defend roads, pilgrims, ports, castles, communications, and frontiers.
c.1119	Jerusalem	Foundation of the early Templar brotherhood. Hugues/Hugh de Payns, Geoffrey/Godfrey of Saint-Omer, and a small group of companions form a religious-military fraternity concerned with protection of Christian pilgrims and defense of the Holy Land. Barber treats 1119 as the conventional founding date. No pope founded the fraternity at this stage.
c.1119-1120s	Temple Mount, Jerusalem	King Baldwin II of Jerusalem supports the new fraternity and provides quarters associated with the former al-Aqsa Mosque on the Temple Mount, understood by Latin Christians as connected with the Temple of Solomon. This contributes to the title Poor Fellow-Soldiers of Christ and of the Temple of Solomon and eventually to the name Templars.
1120s	Jerusalem / Western Europe	Hugues de Payns seeks recruits, donations, property, ecclesiastical recognition, and a

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Date	Place	Event and significance
		formal rule. The new fraternity builds support through aristocratic, ecclesiastical, Champagne, and Cistercian-connected networks.
1120s	Clairvaux / Champagne networks	St. Bernard of Clairvaux, Abbot of Clairvaux and one of the leading Cistercian churchmen of the age, becomes a major theological and ecclesiastical supporter of the emerging Order. Bernard was not a Templar, not its founder, and not the pope who recognized it.
January 1129	Troyes, Champagne	Council of Troyes. During the pontificate of Pope Honorius II, a council operating under papal authority through Cardinal Matthew of Albano formally recognizes the developing Templar fraternity as a religious order. Hugues de Payns presents the fraternity; Bernard of Clairvaux is a powerful intellectual and ecclesiastical influence.
1129	Troyes	The Latin Rule is established/approved. It defines a disciplined religious-military community committed to poverty, chastity, obedience, communal religious observance, austerity, and armed service. Bernard strongly influences the religious ideals and language surrounding the Rule, but it is imprecise to say he personally authored every article.
1129 onward	Cistercian and Templar circles	The early Templar ethos reflects Cistercian reform ideals: austerity, obedience, communal discipline, rejection of luxury, plain dress, and rigorous religious observance. The Templars remain a separate religious order rather than a branch of the Cistercians.
Early 1130s	Clairvaux / Western Christendom	Bernard composes De laude novae militiae (In Praise of the New Knighthood), addressed to Hugues de Payns. He contrasts disciplined religious knighthood with secular warfare motivated by pride, wealth, or prestige and gives a major theological defense of a Christian military vocation.
Early 1130s	Western Christendom	Bernard helps articulate the concept of the New Knighthood: the legitimacy of the religious warrior rests on motive, obedience, discipline, religious profession, and defense of Christians rather than on warfare itself. His support helps make the unusual combination of monastic profession and armed service intelligible within Latin Christianity.
c.1136	Order of the Temple	Hugues de Payns dies and Robert of Craon succeeds as Master. The Order passes from its founding generation into institutional consolidation.

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Date	Place	Event and significance
29 March 1139	Papal authority	Pope Innocent II issues Omne Datum Optimum, the great papal privilege of the Order. It places the Templars and their possessions under direct papal protection and grants major institutional autonomy, including protection of property and internal governance. This is distinct from the c.1119 foundation and the 1129 recognition at Troyes.
1139 onward	Latin Christendom	Under papal protection, the Order becomes a transnational institution with commanderies, estates, recruitment networks, military resources, and financial functions across France, England, Iberia, Italy, German lands, and the eastern Mediterranean. Barber stresses that its principal fame and purpose remained military defense of the Latin East.
9 January 1144	Papal authority	Pope Celestine II issues Milites Templi, adding privileges and spiritual benefits connected with support for the Order.
7 April 1145	Papal authority	Pope Eugenius III issues Militia Dei, further strengthening Templar ecclesiastical privileges, including matters relating to chapels and burial rights. Eugenius had Cistercian associations and was a disciple of Bernard.
1146-1147	Western Europe	Bernard of Clairvaux becomes the leading preacher of the Second Crusade under Pope Eugenius III. This is a later phase of Bernard's career; the Templars are already an established Order.
1147-1149	Europe / Anatolia / Levant	Second Crusade under Louis VII of France and Conrad III of Germany. The Templars function as an experienced military institution; their expertise is important during Louis VII's difficult passage through Anatolia. The wider expedition fails, notably at Damascus.
1149-1152	Order of the Temple	Everard des Barres serves as Grand Master after playing a prominent role during the Second Crusade.
12th century	Europe / Crusader States	The Order expands its commanderies, estates, castles, cavalry, garrisons, transport, and financial capabilities. Its international structure permits deposits, transfers, credit, treasury functions, and movement of funds, though describing it simply as a modern bank is anachronistic.
12th-13th centuries	Latin East	Templars become a permanent frontier force responsible for castles, cavalry, escort operations, garrisons, fortifications, communications, diplomacy, intelligence, and major campaigns. Military orders are

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Date	Place	Event and significance
		among the few institutions capable of maintaining enormous permanent fortresses.
1153	Ascalon	Grand Master Bernard of Tremelay is killed during the siege of Ascalon, illustrating the Order's direct battlefield role.
1154-1184	Latin East	Successive Masters Andrew of Montbard, Bertrand of Blancfort, Philip of Nablus, Odo of Saint-Amand, and Arnold of Torroja preside over the mature development of the Order.
1185	Order of the Temple	Gerard de Ridefort becomes Grand Master. His tenure coincides with the political and military crisis that culminates in the disasters of 1187.
1 May 1187	Cresson, near Nazareth	Battle of Cresson. A small Templar-Hospitaller force engages a much larger Muslim force and suffers devastating losses. Gerard de Ridefort survives. The battle reveals serious political and strategic divisions within the Kingdom of Jerusalem.
4 July 1187	Hattin	Battle of Hattin. Saladin decisively defeats the crusader field army led by King Guy of Lusignan. Many Templars and Hospitallers are captured; large numbers of military-order prisoners are subsequently executed. The defeat destroys much of the military strength of the Kingdom of Jerusalem.
2 October 1187	Jerusalem	Jerusalem is surrendered to Saladin. The Templars lose their original Temple Mount headquarters. The loss is strategically and symbolically enormous, but it does not terminate the Order.
1189-1192	Eastern Mediterranean	Third Crusade. Richard I of England, Philip II of France, Emperor Frederick Barbarossa, Saladin, and the military orders dominate the conflict. The Templars participate extensively.
1191	Acre	Acre is recovered by crusader forces and becomes the principal political and military center of the reduced Latin East.
1191-1192/93	Order of the Temple	Robert de Sable serves as Grand Master and is closely associated with Richard I during the Third Crusade.
1190s-early 1200s	Coastal Levant	Under Gilbert Erail and Philip of Plessis the Templars adapt to a coastal and fortress-based crusader state after the permanent loss of Jerusalem.
1217-1218	Atlit / coastal Palestine	Construction of Chateau Pelerin (Pilgrims' Castle). This enormous Templar fortress demonstrates the resources military orders could devote to permanent defense.

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Date	Place	Event and significance
1217-1221	Egypt / Levant	Fifth Crusade. Crusaders attack Egypt as a strategic center of Muslim power. Damietta is captured in 1219, but the expedition eventually fails. Templars and Hospitallers play major roles.
1219-1230/32	Order of the Temple	Peter of Montaigu serves as Grand Master during continued warfare and complex diplomacy.
1232-1244/46	Order of the Temple	Armand of Perigord serves as Grand Master during increasing instability and the catastrophe of La Forbie.
1239-1240	Holy Land	Crusade of Theobald of Champagne. The military orders act as military and diplomatic institutions amid shifting alliances.
1240-1241	Holy Land	Crusade of Richard of Cornwall continues Western attempts to strengthen the Latin East through diplomacy and limited campaigning.
1240	Safed, Galilee	The Templars begin rebuilding the massive fortress of Safed, demonstrating their continuing commitment to permanent frontier warfare.
17-18 October 1244	La Forbie	Battle of La Forbie. One of the worst crusader defeats since Hattin. Templar and Hospitaller casualties are enormous; Armand of Perigord disappears or dies in captivity.
c.1247-1250	Order of the Temple	William of Sonnac serves as Grand Master during Louis IX's Egyptian crusade.
1248-1254	Egypt / Holy Land	Seventh Crusade under Louis IX of France. The Templars play a major military role in the expedition.
1250	Mansurah, Egypt	Battle of Mansurah. Grand Master William of Sonnac is killed. Louis IX is later captured and the crusade ends unsuccessfully.
1250-1273	Latin East	Reginald of Vichiers and Thomas Berard lead the Order as Mamluk pressure increases and Latin territory contracts.
1266	Safed	Sultan Baybars captures Safed during the systematic Mamluk reduction of crusader strongholds.
1271-1272	Levant	Edward's Crusade under the future Edward I of England, the last major Western expedition to reach the Levant before the fall of Acre.
1273-1291	Order of the Temple	William of Beaujeu serves as Grand Master during the final generation of Templar warfare in the Holy Land.
18 May 1291	Acre	Fall of Acre to the Mamluk Sultan al-Ashraf

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Date	Place	Event and significance
		Khalil. William of Beaujeu is mortally wounded defending the city. The fall destroys the principal remaining Latin military center and marks the collapse of the major crusader presence in Palestine.
1291	Tortosa / Atlit / Cyprus	The Templars evacuate remaining mainland positions including Tortosa and Atlit/Pilgrims' Castle. Central operations shift principally to Cyprus. The Order remains a legal and functioning religious corporation, still concerned with crusading strategy, European estates, and finance, but the territorial mission for which it had become famous has largely disappeared.
1291-1292/93	Cyprus	Theobald Gaudin serves as Grand Master during the immediate post-Acre transition.
c.1293	Order of the Temple	Jacques de Molay becomes Grand Master. He seeks to preserve Templar independence and revive crusading prospects.
1290s-1300s	Papacy / military orders	Debate grows over the future and possible merger of the Templars and Hospitallers. Molay resists a simplistic merger and continues to advocate renewed crusading plans.
1302	Ruad / Arwad	The Templar garrison on Ruad is defeated; many brothers are killed or captured. This effectively ends the Temple's final military foothold immediately off the Syrian coast.
Early 1300s	France / papal court	Philip IV of France rules an increasingly centralized monarchy under substantial fiscal pressure. His ministers include Guillaume de Nogaret and Guillaume de Plaisians. Philip had already clashed dramatically with Pope Boniface VIII. The Temple's wealth, privileges, and financial relationship with the crown form part of the context, but Barber cautions against reducing the prosecution to a single debt-seizure motive.
1305	Papacy	Clement V becomes pope and inherits questions concerning crusading reform, the military orders, and French political pressure.
14 September 1307	France	Philip IV issues secret instructions for a coordinated arrest of the French Templars. The principal early accusation groups include denial of Christ and abuse of the cross; obscene or improper kissing and alleged homosexuality; and alleged idol or head worship.
13 October 1307	France	Mass arrest of Templars throughout France, including Grand Master Jacques de Molay. Royal officials seize property and imprison

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Date	Place	Event and significance
		members. This is the beginning of the French royal attack, not the legal suppression of the Order.
October 1307 onward	France	Interrogation and torture. Guillaume de Paris, Inquisitor of France and royal confessor, participates in proceedings. Prisoners are isolated and coercive methods are extensively used. Numerous confessions obtained under these conditions have deeply problematic evidentiary value.
1307	France	Charges include denial of Christ; spitting, trampling, or other abuse of the cross; improper ritual kisses; alleged homosexual practices; alleged worship of a head, idol, or cat; improper absolution by lay superiors; secrecy; and other alleged ritual or sacramental irregularities. These are accusations and should not be recorded as established facts.
Late 1307	Papacy / France	Pope Clement V objects to Philip IV's unilateral seizure of an Order directly accountable to papal authority. A jurisdictional struggle develops between royal prosecution and ecclesiastical control.
22 November 1307	Papal authority / Europe	Clement V issues Pastoralis Praeeminentiae, ordering Christian rulers to arrest Templars and sequester property pending ecclesiastical investigation. The affair becomes an international Church matter rather than merely a French royal proceeding.
1307-1308	England, Iberia, Italy, German lands, elsewhere	Reactions outside France differ substantially. Edward II of England initially expresses skepticism. Barber's comparative work shows that jurisdictions limiting torture frequently produce different results from France.
February 1308	Papal authority	Clement temporarily suspends inquisitorial activity in an effort to regain control of the process while French political pressure intensifies.
1308	Europe	Proceedings are reorganized. A crucial distinction develops between trials of individual Templars through episcopal or inquisitorial processes and investigation of the Order as a corporate institution through papal commissions. An individual confession does not automatically establish corporate heresy.
June-July 1308	Poitiers	Numerous Templars are questioned before papal representatives, bringing parts of the inquiry directly under papal supervision.
12 August 1308	Papal investigation	The accusation structure expands into 127

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Date	Place	Event and significance
		articles covering denial of Christ, alleged idolatry, sacramental irregularities, improper absolution, obscene kisses, alleged sexual misconduct, secrecy, and supposed institutional corruption.
17-20 August 1308	Chateau de Chinon	Chinon proceedings. Three cardinals acting under Pope Clement V - Bérenger Frédol, Étienne de Suisy, and Landolfo Brancaccio - examine senior Templar leaders Jacques de Molay, Hugues de Pairaud, Geoffroy de Gonneville, Geoffroy de Charney, and Raimbaud de Caron.
August 1308	Chinon	The senior leaders admit certain irregular initiation practices, express repentance, profess Catholic faith, and receive absolution from ecclesiastical censures and reconciliation with the Church. Chinon establishes that Clement's representatives did not treat these leaders as permanently outside the Church. It is not a blanket acquittal of every Templar or every charge and it does not terminate the corporate investigation.
1308 onward	Church proceedings	The Chinon distinction remains fundamental: absolution of named individual leaders and the continued legal existence of the corporate Order are separate questions. Chinon neither secretly creates a successor Order nor prevents the later suppression.
1309-1311	Paris	A papal commission investigates the Order corporately. Hundreds of Templars eventually indicate willingness to defend the institution.
1309-1310	Paris	Pierre de Bologna, a legally knowledgeable Templar priest, and Renaud de Provins emerge as prominent defenders. They challenge the reliability of confessions produced through coercion and attempt to defend the Order institutionally.
28 November 1309	Paris	Jacques de Molay appears before the papal commission. Guillaume de Nogaret attempts to use older allegations about Templar conduct and crusading failures as evidence of longstanding corruption; Molay contests the allegations.
4 April 1310	Papal authority	Clement V postpones the Council of Vienne through Alma mater because the proceedings are taking longer than anticipated. The organized Templar defense is gaining significant momentum.
Second week of May 1310	Province of Sens / Paris	Royal pressure intensifies. Philippe de Marigny, Archbishop of Sens and brother of royal minister Enguerrand de Marigny,

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Date	Place	Event and significance
		presides over proceedings that strike directly at the Templar defense.
12 May 1310	Near Paris	Fifty-four Templars already judged relapsed heretics are handed to secular authority and burned. The mass execution terrifies the defenders and largely breaks the organized corporate defense.
After May 1310	Paris	Pierre de Bologna disappears from the proceedings under uncertain circumstances; Renaud de Provins receives perpetual imprisonment. The Order's organized legal defense is substantially weakened.
1307-1311	Europe	Papal, episcopal, inquisitorial, and secular proceedings vary greatly across jurisdictions. Barber emphasizes that extensive confessions are concentrated most strongly where French influence and torture are greatest, while other regions often produce much weaker evidence.
June 1311	Paris / papal court	The Paris papal commission winds down. Clement possesses a large but inconsistent evidentiary record from France and other parts of Europe.
16 October 1311	Vienne	Council of Vienne opens under Pope Clement V. The council must confront two separate issues: whether corporate heresy has been judicially proved and whether the Order can realistically continue amid scandal, political pressure, and institutional paralysis.
1311-1312	Vienne / France	Philip IV continues intense political pressure. The final outcome is not a simple completed adversarial trial followed by a corporate judicial conviction of heresy.
22 March 1312	Papal authority / Council of Vienne	Clement V issues Vox in excelso and suppresses the Order of the Temple by apostolic provision. This is the decisive institutional termination point. Suppression is not identical to a definitive corporate judicial conviction for heresy; however, the absence of such a conviction does not mean the Order continued legally after 1312.
2 May 1312	Papal authority	Clement V issues Ad providam. Much former Templar property is transferred to the Knights Hospitaller, with important Iberian exceptions. The Hospitallers become property recipients, not the same institution as the Templars.
1312 onward	Iberian kingdoms	Former Templar resources, personnel, or functions contribute to new arrangements, notably the Order of Christ in Portugal and later the Order of Montesa in Aragon. These are new institutions with particular property or functional succession, not

Date	Place	Event and significance
		proven secret continuations of the Temple.
1312-1314	Europe	Individual former Templars receive varying outcomes depending on jurisdiction: imprisonment, pensions, penance, transfer to other religious houses, acquittal, or other dispositions.
March 1314	Paris	Final sentencing of surviving senior leaders. Jacques de Molay and Geoffroy de Charney publicly repudiate earlier admissions and reaffirm the innocence of the Order. Under medieval heresy procedure they are treated as relapsed heretics.
Traditionally 18 March 1314	Paris	Jacques de Molay and Geoffroy de Charney are burned by secular authority. The exact March date has been debated, though 18 March is traditional. Their execution marks the dramatic end of the recognized medieval Templar leadership; it does not constitute the legal suppression, which had already occurred in 1312.

3.2 Four distinct stages in the Order's early institutional formation

- c.1119 - Foundation: Hugues de Payns and his companions form the fraternity in Jerusalem. No pope founds the initial brotherhood.
- January 1129 - Formal Church recognition: under Pope Honorius II, the Council of Troyes recognizes the Order through proceedings under papal authority.
- 1129-early 1130s - Theological definition: St. Bernard of Clairvaux helps shape and defend the religious ideal of the New Knighthood and writes In Praise of the New Knighthood.
- 29 March 1139 - Great papal privilege: Pope Innocent II issues Omne Datum Optimum, giving the Templars direct papal protection and extensive institutional privileges.

3.3 Principal Grand Masters

Grand Master	Approximate tenure
Hugues de Payns	1119-c.1136
Robert of Craon	c.1136-1149
Everard des Barres	1149-1152
Bernard of Tremelay	1153
Andrew of Montbard	1154-1156
Bertrand of Blancfort	1156-1169
Philip of Nablus	1169-1171
Odo of Saint-Amand	c.1171-1179
Arnold of Torroja	1181-1184

Grand Master	Approximate tenure
Gerard de Ridefort	1185-1189
Robert de Sable	1191-1192/93
Gilbert Erail	1194-1200
Philip of Plessis	1201-1209
William of Chartres	1210-1218/19
Peter of Montaigu	1219-1230/32
Armand of Perigord	c.1232-1244/46
William of Sonnac	c.1247-1250
Reginald of Vichiers	1250-1256
Thomas Berard	1256-1273
William of Beaujeu	1273-1291
Theobald Gaudin	1291-1292/93
Jacques de Molay	c.1293-1314

3.4 Major people in the integrated historical narrative

Person	Role and significance
Pope Urban II	Called the First Crusade in 1095; did not found the Templars.
King Baldwin II of Jerusalem	Supported the early fraternity and provided its Jerusalem base associated with the Temple Mount.
Hugues de Payns	Founding Master of the Templar fraternity, c.1119.
Geoffrey/Godfrey of Saint-Omer	Traditional early companion and founder.
Pope Honorius II	Reigning pope when the Order received formal ecclesiastical recognition at Troyes in 1129.
Cardinal Matthew of Albano	Papal legate whose authority was central to the Council of Troyes.
St. Bernard of Clairvaux	Cistercian abbot; principal early theological champion; major influence on the religious ideals surrounding the Latin Rule; author of In Praise of the New Knighthood; later chief preacher of the Second Crusade. He was neither a Templar nor the founder of the Order.
Pope Innocent II	Issued Omne Datum Optimum in 1139.
Pope Celestine II	Issued Milites Templi in 1144.
Pope Eugenius III	Issued Militia Dei in 1145 and authorized the Second Crusade.

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Person	Role and significance
Louis VII and Conrad III	Principal rulers of the Second Crusade.
Saladin	Muslim ruler whose victories at Hattin and Jerusalem transformed the strategic situation in 1187.
Gerard de Ridefort	Templar Grand Master during Cresson and Hattin.
Guy of Lusignan	King of Jerusalem at the Battle of Hattin.
Richard I	Major leader of the Third Crusade.
Robert de Sable	Templar Grand Master associated with Richard I.
Louis IX	Led the Seventh Crusade and Egyptian campaign.
William of Sonnac	Grand Master killed during the Egyptian campaign.
Baybars	Mamluk Sultan whose campaigns reduced major crusader fortresses including Safed.
William of Beaujeu	Grand Master killed defending Acre in 1291.
al-Ashraf Khalil	Mamluk Sultan who captured Acre.
Theobald Gaudin	Grand Master during the immediate post-Acre transition to Cyprus.
Jacques de Molay	Last recognized medieval Grand Master; sought renewed crusading action; arrested in 1307; examined and reconciled at Chinon; executed in 1314 after repudiating earlier admissions.
Philip IV of France	Principal secular force behind the coordinated arrests and French prosecution beginning in 1307.
Pope Clement V	Asserted papal jurisdiction, authorized wider ecclesiastical proceedings, stood behind the Chinon commission, and ultimately suppressed the Order in 1312.
Guillaume de Nogaret	Major royal lawyer and political strategist in the attack on the Templars.
Guillaume de Plaisians	Royal lawyer and polemicist involved in the prosecution.
Guillaume de Paris	Inquisitor of France and royal confessor involved in interrogations.
Bérenger Frédol, Étienne de Suisy, Landolfo Brancaccio	The three cardinal commissioners who examined the senior Templar leaders at Chinon.
Hugues de Pairaud, Raimbaud de Caron, Geoffroy de Gonneville, Geoffroy de Charney	Senior Templar officials examined at Chinon alongside Jacques de Molay.
Philippe de Marigny	Archbishop of Sens whose proceedings contributed to the May 1310 executions that shattered the organized Templar defense.
Enguerrand de Marigny	Powerful royal minister and brother of Philippe de Marigny.
Pierre de Bologna	Legally knowledgeable Templar priest and leading defender of the corporate Order.

Person	Role and significance
Renaud de Provins	Prominent Templar defender; later sentenced to perpetual imprisonment.

3.5 Consolidated accusations and legal-procedural structure

The prosecution ultimately alleged denial of Christ during reception; spitting, trampling, or other abuse of the cross; denial of Christ's salvific character; worship of an idol, mysterious head, or sometimes a cat; improper ritual kissing; encouragement or tolerance of homosexual acts; corruption or disbelief concerning sacraments; omission of consecratory words in Mass; improper absolution of sins by lay Templar superiors; secret chapters and receptions; and institutional concealment of alleged misconduct. The early 1307 case concentrated especially on denial and abuse of the cross, improper kissing/sexual allegations, and alleged idol worship; by August 1308 the allegations had expanded into 127 articles. These propositions are accusations, not proven facts.

The phrase civil trial is insufficient for the proceedings. The process combined French royal action (arrests, imprisonment, property seizure, and political pressure), inquisitorial investigation of heresy, episcopal proceedings against individuals, papal commissions addressing the Order corporately, and secular execution of persons handed over as relapsed heretics. Heresy remained fundamentally an ecclesiastical legal question even though the French crown supplied much of the coercive machinery.

3.6 Historical interpretation retained for the larger project

The historical Knights Templar were a papally recognized transnational religious-military corporation that existed for nearly two centuries. Their development moved from a small Jerusalem fraternity through ecclesiastical recognition, Cistercian-influenced religious definition, papal privilege, international expansion, permanent crusading warfare, the loss of Jerusalem, repeated military crises, and finally the loss of Acre and Ruad. The prosecution beginning in 1307 was a prolonged struggle involving royal power, papal jurisdiction, coercive inquisitorial procedure, local ecclesiastical trials, an organized defense, and intense political pressure. Chinon demonstrates reconciliation of named senior leaders; Vox in excelso in 1312 nevertheless suppresses the corporate Order. The two facts must be held together rather than using either one to erase the other.

4. The Trial, Chinon Parchment, Suppression, and Modern Rediscovery

4.1 Philip IV and the arrests of 1307

Philip IV of France faced severe fiscal pressures and had a complex financial relationship with the Temple. Those circumstances form part of the political context, but they should not be treated as the conclusively proven single motive for the arrests. Modern historians, including Malcolm Barber, treat the motives as contested and involving financial, political, jurisdictional, and religious dimensions. The charges included denial of Christ, spitting or trampling on the cross, improper or

obscene kissing, alleged homosexual practices, alleged idol or head worship, improper absolution, and secrecy surrounding reception rites.

Numerous French confessions were obtained under imprisonment, coercion, and extensive use of torture. The presence of coercion makes the evidentiary value of many confessions deeply problematic. Proceedings outside France did not reproduce the French results uniformly.

4.2 The Chinon Parchment

The Chinon Parchment records the interrogation of senior Templar leaders at the Chateau de Chinon in August 1308 by three cardinals acting under papal authority. The leaders included Jacques de Molay, Hugues de Pairaud, Geoffroi de Gonneville, Geoffroi de Charney, and Raimbaud de Caron. After confession, repentance, and professions of Catholic faith, the commissioners granted absolution from ecclesiastical censures and reconciled the men to the Church.

The parchment does not amount to a blanket acquittal of every member of the Order or every allegation. It does establish that Clement V did not simply treat the senior leadership as permanently condemned heretics at that stage. The broader investigation continued, and the eventual suppression in 1312 remained legally effective.

4.3 What Chinon does not establish

- It does not name a post-1312 successor Order.
- It does not transfer the medieval corporation to a clandestine organization.
- It does not appoint a secret succession of Grand Masters.
- It does not authenticate the Larmenius Charter.
- It does not establish the 1804 Fabré-Palaprat organization as the legal medieval Order.
- It does not canonically restore OSMTH, OSMTJ, SMOTJ, OPCCTS, or any other modern Templar body.
- It does not rescind the later suppression enacted through Vox in excelso.

4.4 Suppression rather than a simple corporate heresy conviction

The strongest formulation for the record is that Clement V suppressed the Order by papal administrative provision rather than after a completed definitive judicial determination by the Council of Vienne that the Order as a corporation had been proved heretical. This distinction matters. The Order was institutionally suppressed, but the historical legal process is more complex than the popular shorthand that the Church simply convicted the entire Order of heresy and abolished it.

4.5 Barbara Frale and modern publication

Date	Development
2001	Barbara Frale identifies the significance of the poorly catalogued Chinon archival document in the Vatican archive. Journalistic shorthand often calls it “misfiled,” but “poorly/inadequately catalogued” is safer.
2003	Frale publishes a detailed scholarly study of the

Date	Development
	previously unpublished Chinon absolution.
2007	The Vatican archive and Scrinium publish Processus contra Templarios, a critical facsimile edition of major surviving trial records including Chinon. This is an archival publication, not a restoration of the Order.

4.6 Malcolm Charles Barber as a core secondary authority

Field	Record
Name	Professor Malcolm Charles Barber
Status	Emeritus Professor of History, University of Reading
Fields	High Middle Ages, Crusades, military orders, Knights Templar, Catharism
Major work	The Trial of the Templars (first published 1978; second edition 2006)
Major work	The New Knighthood: A History of the Order of the Temple (1994)
Use in this project	Tier I academic secondary authority; interpretations remain distinct from papal acts and other primary documents

5. Classification Framework

The research ultimately requires three top-level categories, with subcategories for analytical precision.

Category	Name	Definition
Category 1	Historical Order / demonstrated medieval legal continuity	The medieval Order itself, c.1119-1312. No presently identified modern body is established as its juridical continuation by the Chinon Parchment. Property recipients such as the Hospitallers are property successors, not the Templar corporation.
Category 2	Masonic Templary	Eighteenth-century and later Christian Masonic chivalric systems. Relationship to medieval Templars is commemorative, symbolic, ritual, devotional, moral, and historical homage rather than demonstrated corporate descent.

Category	Name	Definition
Category 3	Neo-/Pseudo-Templar organizations	Modern revivalist, derivative, independent Christian, Catholic-restoration, esoteric, or direct-succession-claiming organizations that use Templar identity without demonstrated juridical continuity from the medieval corporation.

6. Master Classification Table

Cat.	Institution	Modern date	Relationship to Templar identity	Masonic?	Catholic?	Classification
1	Medieval Knights Templar / Order of the Temple	c.1119-1312	Original historical Order	No	Medieval Catholic religious-military Order	Historical Order
1	Knights Hospitaller / Order of St. John	Independent medieval origin	Received much former Templar property under Ad providam	No	Catholic origin	Property successor only, not Templar successor
2	Grand Encampment, Knights Templar, U.S.A.	1816	Masonic Christian chivalric body	Yes	No institutional Roman Catholic control	Masonic Templary
2	Great Priory of England & Wales	1791	Masonic Christian chivalric body	Yes	No institutional Roman Catholic control	Masonic Templary
2	Great Priory of Scotland	1811	Masonic Christian chivalric body	Yes	No institutional Roman Catholic control	Masonic Templary
2	Great Priory of Ireland	1837 / 1872	Masonic Christian chivalric body	Yes	No institutional Roman Catholic control	Masonic Templary
2	Sovereign Great Priory of Canada	1855 / 1868 / 1884	Masonic Christian chivalric body	Yes	No institutional Roman Catholic control	Masonic Templary
2	Australian Masonic Great Priories	19th-20th c.	Masonic Christian chivalric bodies	Yes	No institutional Roman Catholic control	Masonic Templary
3	Fabré-Palaprat Ordre du Temple	1804	Modern neo-Templar revival	Historical Masonic milieu	No	Revivalist neo-Templar
3	Belgian OSMTJ	1932	Modern neo-Templar organization	No current institutional tie	No	OSMTJ derivative
3	Sousa Fontes / Porto OSMTH tradition	1940s	Neo-Templar administration	No current institutional tie	No	OSMTH/OSMTJ derivative
3	Zdrojewski OSMTJ	1970	Independent branch	No	No	OSMTJ derivative

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Cat.	Institution	Modern date	Relationship to Templar identity	Masonic?	Catholic?	Classification
3	SMOTJ-USA	1962 corporate charter	Modern ecumenical Templar organization	No	No	Neo-Templar order
3	Swiss OSMTH	1995-96 formation; 1999 Swiss registration	Modern ecumenical Templar organization; explicitly does not assert direct medieval descent	No	No	Neo-Templar order
3	OSMTHU / IFA	late 1990s	Federative neo-Templar lineage	No institutional tie	Ecumenical contacts	Neo-Templar derivative
3	OIMT	c.1979	Ecumenical Templar federation	No demonstrated control	Catholic connection through initiating figure	Neo-Templar federation
3	Autonomous Grand Priory of Scotland	2006 precursor / 2009 Grand Priory	Independent Christian Templar body	Explicitly non-Masonic	No Roman Catholic jurisdiction	Independent neo-Templar
3	OPCCTS / Knights Templar of North America	1995 claimed first use; 2011 Texas nonprofit; later 2018 reorganization claim	Independent current body with Porto/Sousa Fontes provenance	Explicitly non-Masonic	No	Derivative neo-Templar
3	Knights Templar International Novus Ordo Militiae Ltd.	16 June 2015	Northern Ireland company limited by guarantee	No	No	Independent modern neo-Templar
3	Militia Templi	17 May 1979; canonical recognition 1988	Catholic private association/restoration; explicitly rejects direct juridical descent	No	Yes	Catholic Templar restoration
3	Templari Oggi APS / Templars Today	March 2021	Catholic lay/service association	No evidence of Masonic identity	Yes	Catholic Templar-inspired association
3	OSTI	1988	Esoteric initiatory Templar body	Founder connected to Freemasonry	No	Esoteric neo-Templar
3	Ordre Renove du Temple	1970	French esoteric Templar body	Founder Raymond Bernard had Masonic associations	No	Esoteric neo-Templar
3	Order of the Solar Temple	1984	Esoteric/cultic neo-Templar body	Esoteric milieu	No	Defunct extremist/cultic neo-Templar
3	Order of the Temple of Solomon	Modern restoration claims 2013/2015	Claims direct juridical/canonical continuity	No	Claims separate ecclesiastical status	Claimed direct successor; continuity not independently established
3	Association /	Modern Spanish	Claims succession	No established	No established	Claimed successor;

Cat.	Institution	Modern date	Relationship to Templar identity	Masonic?	Catholic?	Classification
	Sovereign Order of the Temple of Christ	claimant	and pursued Vatican litigation		canonical recognition	not independently established

7. Modern Neo-Templar and Templar-Inspired Organizations

7.1 Fabré-Palaprat Ordre du Temple (1804)

Bernard-Raymond Fabré-Palaprat is the principal founder of the modern 1804 Order of the Temple in Paris. Philippe Ledru, Claude-Mathieu, and Radix de Cheyllon are associated with the founding circle in later organizational histories.

The 1804 body is the critical ancestor claimed by much later OSMTJ/OSMTH neo-Templarism. Fabré-Palaprat promoted the Larmenius Charter as evidence of post-Molay succession, but mainstream medieval scholarship does not accept that document as establishing uninterrupted juridical continuity from the medieval Order.

The founding milieu had significant Masonic involvement. Accordingly, later organizations may accurately describe themselves as non-Masonic today while still possessing a genealogy that passes through a modern revival shaped by Freemasons.

7.2 Belgian OSMTJ (1932)

The Ordre Souverain et Militaire du Temple de Jerusalem was registered in Brussels on 19 January 1932. Organizational histories identify Joseph Cleeremans, Gustave Jonckbloedt, and Theodore Covias among the reconstituting figures. Notice was reported as appearing in the Belgian Monitor on 20 January 1933; later registrations occurred in Namur.

This Belgian organization became a principal twentieth-century ancestor of competing OSMTH and OSMTJ obediences.

7.3 Sousa Fontes / Porto line

During the Second World War and its aftermath, records and authority claims moved into the orbit of Antonio Campello Pinto de Sousa Fontes in Portugal. His administration became central to the Porto/Sousa Fontes lineage. His son Fernando Campello Pinto Pereira de Sousa Fontes later claimed succession.

The movement is not institutionally Roman Catholic or Masonic today, but its wider asserted neo-Templar genealogy runs through the 1804 revival.

7.4 Zdrojewski line

In 1970 a major schism produced a competing line under General Antoine Jozef Zdrojewski. Several Grand Priorities rejected aspects of the Sousa Fontes succession and elected Zdrojewski. This produced one of the most consequential divisions in modern neo-Templarism.

7.5 SMOTJ - Autonomous Grand Priory of the United States

The U.S. organization received a New Jersey corporate charter on 29 June 1962 in Newark. Crolan William Edelen served as an early Grand Prior from 1962 to 1965.

SMOTJ is ecumenical Christian, not Roman Catholic-controlled, and not a Masonic body. It does not need to assert a secret medieval survival chain to exist as a modern organization.

7.6 Swiss OSMTH

The Swiss-registered OSMTH emerged from the 1995-1996 separation of Grand Priories dissatisfied with Fernando de Sousa Fontes. The association was registered in Geneva on 25 October 1999 under CH-660.1.972.999-4 / CHE-101.134.939.

Formative leadership included Lt. Col. Joseph Esposito and Maj.-Gen. Sir Roy Redgrave together with participating national Grand Priories. OSMTH describes itself as an ecumenical Christian international organization and explicitly states that it does not assert direct descent from the medieval Knights Templar.

7.7 OIMT

Ordo Internationalis Militiae Templi developed around 1979 as a confederation of ecumenical Christian Templar associations. Dom Johannes Becker, described in OSMTH histories as a Roman Catholic canon working in Rome, was an initiating figure. This gives the organization a real Catholic historical connection without necessarily making it a juridically Roman Catholic body.

7.8 OSMTHU / International Federative Alliance

The International Federative Alliance emerged among autonomous Grand Priories in the late twentieth century and developed into OSMTHU. Fernando de Toro-Garland and later Antonio Paris are associated with its modern leadership. The organization describes its Templar identity as spiritual/chivalric rather than as proven direct medieval descent.

7.9 Autonomous Grand Priory of Scotland

The Autonomous Grand Priory of Scotland developed after the rupture of Militi Templi Scotia. A predecessor commandery was chartered in 2006, and the Grand Priory was chartered in 2009 at Balgonie Castle. George Stewart and founding knights are associated with the reorganization.

The organization expressly describes itself as non-Masonic and ecumenical Christian. It is therefore one of the clearest examples of an independent modern Christian neo-Templar body rather than a Masonic Templar institution.

7.10 Knights Templar International - Novus Ordo Militiae Ltd.

Knights Templar International Novus Ordo Militiae Limited was incorporated in Northern Ireland on 16 June 2015 as company NI631938, a private company limited by guarantee without share capital. Marion Thomas was a director from incorporation; Bernadette Noeleen Muresan was also an incorporation-day director and resigned the same day.

The legal company should be distinguished from broader publicity, ideological leadership, or claimed historical identity.

7.11 Militia Templi - Christi Pauperum Militum Ordo

Militia Templi was founded by public deed on 17 May 1979 by Count Marcello Alberto Cristofani della Magione in Tuscany and received civil recognition on 21 September 1979. Canonical recognition followed on 8 September 1988 under Archbishop Mario Jsmalee Castellano of Siena.

It operates as a Catholic private association of the faithful and explicitly rejects claims of juridical descent from the medieval Order. It presents itself as a modern Catholic restoration of Templar spirituality and Christian chivalry.

7.12 Templari Oggi APS / Templars Today

Templari Oggi is a modern Catholic lay association founded in March 2021. During the 2025 Jubilee it entered into an agreement with the Dicastery for Evangelization to provide volunteer pilgrim assistance at major Roman basilicas, including St. Peter's, St. John Lateran, and St. Paul Outside the Walls.

This is genuine documented cooperation with a Holy See dicastery, but it is not a canonical restoration of the medieval Knights Templar.

7.13 French esoteric neo-Templar stream

The twentieth-century French esoteric stream includes the Ordre Renove du Temple (1970, Raymond Bernard with Julien Origas), Ordre des Veilleurs du Temple - Militia Templi (1973), Ordre Ressuscite du Temple (1974, Michel Carpenet), Cercle du Temple et du Saint-Graal (1975), Fraternite Johannite pour la Resurgence Templiere (1978), Ordre du Temple Cosmique (1978), OSTI (1988, Raymond Bernard), and the Order of the Solar Temple (1984, Joseph Di Mambro and Luc Jouret).

These bodies belong to esoteric neo-Templarism, not ordinary Masonic Templary, even where founders personally participated in Freemasonry or Rosicrucianism.

7.14 Direct-succession claimant organizations

The Order of the Temple of Solomon / Sovereign Magistral Order of the Temple of Solomon makes unusually strong modern claims of direct canonical, legal, and juridical continuation from the medieval Temple. The organization describes a modern restoration around 2013 and constitutional developments in 2015-2016. The claim remains an organizational assertion unless independently validated by a documentary bridge across 1312.

A modern Spanish Association / Sovereign Order of the Temple of Christ has likewise claimed Templar succession and pursued litigation seeking recognition, rehabilitation, and property-related remedies from the Vatican. Litigation proves the existence of the claim, not the truth of medieval juridical succession.

8. OPCCTS / Knights Templar of North America - Corrected Record

Field	Corrected record
Current public name	Knights Templar of North America
Formal name	Ordo Pauperum Commilitum Christi et Templi Solomonis,

Field	Corrected record
	Equites Templi (OPCCTS)
Current public contact	P.O. Box 274, Justin, Texas 76247
Historical organizational emergence	Circa 1995 according to older OPCCTS material and claimed first-use evidence
Texas legal incorporation	24 January 2011, domestic nonprofit corporation; public aggregations report Texas number 32043469959
Earlier officers	Brent G. Batla - Master of the House; Thomas M. Bozzuto - Great Preceptor; Nathan M. Fredrickson - Seneschal; Vincent G. Zubras - Director
Historical registered agent	Corporation Service Company d/b/a CSC-Lawyers Incorporating Service Company, Austin, Texas; current agent still requires direct Texas Secretary of State confirmation
Federal EIN	27-4655540
501(c)(3)	IRS-derived nonprofit databases reflect charitable/community-service classification and exemption recognition around March 2019
Federal trademark	Application filed 12 February 2016; registered 21 February 2017, Reg. No. 5,148,050; claimed first use 1 June 1995
Caleb Goeke	Reported founder/reorganizer of the present Knights Templar of North America incarnation at Justin, Texas on 25 October 2018. He cannot presently be treated as the original founder of OPCCTS because the OPCCTS organization and legal entity predate 2018.
Masonic affiliation	Organization expressly states that it is not associated with a Masonic Order
Roman Catholic affiliation	No current institutional Roman Catholic affiliation; organization presents itself as Christian/ecumenical
Modern Templar provenance	Older OPCCTS literature places the organization in the Porto/Sousa Fontes side of the wider modern Templar dispute and describes it as an autonomous child of a European parent tradition
Relationship to American SMOTJ	Historically related to the same wider OSMTH controversy but OPCCTS explicitly denies derivation from or association with the competing American SMOTJ / Autonomous Grand Priory corporation

The key amendment is that 25 October 2018 cannot be used as the original legal founding date of OPCCTS. The date may mark a later reorganization or the launch of the present Knights Templar of North America identity under Caleb Goeke. The underlying OPCCTS record is older.

9. Masonic Templary: Institutional Character and Historical Development

9.1 What Masonic Templary claims - and does not claim

The Grand Encampment of Knights Templar, U.S.A. does not claim institutional descent from the medieval Knights Templar. Its educational material expressly states that the modern Masonic organization does not claim to be a direct descendant of the medieval Order. Its mission is to provide every Christian Freemason the opportunity to extend his Masonic journey through the chivalric experience.

Accordingly, the project adopts a permanent correction: Masonic Knights Templar do not claim that medieval Templars escaped arrest by systematically infiltrating operative mason guilds or that modern Freemasonry is the hidden continuation of the medieval Order. Individual writers have proposed such theories, but those private theories are not to be attributed to Freemasonry institutionally unless an official body expressly adopts them.

9.2 Institutional purpose

- Christian moral and spiritual formation for Freemasons.
- Chivalric ritual and moral allegory.
- Fellowship and fraternal education.
- Christian worship and devotional observance.
- Charitable activity and service.
- Historical and symbolic homage to Christian knighthood and the medieval crusading era.

9.3 Major Masonic Templar governing bodies

Body	Formation	Place	Founding / organizing notes
Grand Encampment, Knights Templar, U.S.A.	20-21 June 1816	New York City	Thomas Smith Webb, Henry Fowle, John Snow, Thomas Lowndes were principal organizers; DeWitt Clinton first Grand Master
Great Priory of England & Wales	1791 as Grand Conclave	England	Thomas Dunckerley and constituent Encampments
Great Priory of Scotland	1811	Scotland	Charter from Duke of Kent; Alexander Deuchar first Grand Master
Great Priory of Ireland	Supreme Grand Encampment 1837; Great Priory 1872	Ireland	Supreme Grand Encampment under the Duke of Leinster
Sovereign Great Priory of Canada	1855 continuous organization; 1868 Grand Priory; 1884 sovereign body	Canada	W. J. B. MacLeod Moore central organizer
Great Priory of Queensland	1985 independent; local Templary from 1865	Queensland, Australia	Earlier organizer William Martin Boyce
NSW / ACT Templary	Documented from 1845	Australia	Various Masonic warrants

10. Earliest Recorded Masonic Templar Degrees and Conferrals

The research distinguishes an early Templar-themed Masonic degree from the later recognizable Anglo-American Order of the Temple. Continental Europe shows Templar themes earlier than surviving Anglo-American conferral records.

Date	Place	Degree/development	Significance	Evidence
1737	Paris	Ramsay's Oration	Andrew Michael Ramsay connects Freemasonry rhetorically with crusading chivalry. Important ideological precursor, not itself a Knight Templar degree.	A - documented
c.1743	France	Early Kadosh / Templar attribution	Later Masonic literature sometimes dates an early Kadosh-type form to this period. Documentation is less secure and should be treated as traditional/retrospective.	C - traditional
c.1750	Quimper / France	Chevalier Elu / Chosen Knight	Specialist research identifies an early explicitly Templar-themed Masonic degree in this environment.	B - strong secondary
c.1751	Germany / Continental Europe	Strict Observance emerging	Von Hund's system develops a formal Templar grade and increasingly explicit Templar structure.	A-/B+
1758	France	Kadosh terminology in high-degree systems	Kadosh appears within French high-degree organization; later forms include explicit Templar martyrdom/justice themes.	B+
1760s	Continental Europe	Templar high-degree proliferation	Clermont, Kadosh, Strict Observance and other chivalric systems are circulating.	A - well documented
28 Aug. 1769	Boston	William Davis receives Knight Templar	Earliest securely documented conferral of the recognizable Anglo-American Order of the Temple in surviving North American minutes.	A+
11 Dec. 1769	Boston	Paul Revere receives Knight Templar	Firm documentary record.	A+
14 May 1770	Boston	Joseph Warren receives Knight Templar	Firm documentary record.	A+

Date	Place	Degree/development	Significance	Evidence
1770s-1790s	Britain / Ireland / America	Encampments and dedicated Templar bodies appear	Transition from detached or chapter-conferral practice toward dedicated Templar governance.	A/B
1791	England	Grand Conclave	National English Masonic Templar organization under Thomas Dunckerley.	A+
1816	United States	Grand Encampment	National American Masonic Templar organization.	A+

10.1 William Davis and the Boston record

On 28 August 1769, Captain William Davis, a Past Master associated with a British Army lodge, received a sequence recorded as Excellent, Super Excellent, Royal Arch, and Knight Templar in the Boston Masonic environment connected with St. Andrew's Lodge/Royal Arch work. The Grand Encampment recognizes this as the first recorded conferral of the Order of the Temple in North America. Paul Revere followed on 11 December 1769 and Joseph Warren on 14 May 1770.

10.2 Why 1769 remains especially important

An 1891 Masonic periodical discussing Frederic Speed's historical work stated that the Boston 1769 record was the earliest account then discovered of the conferral of the Knight Templar degree in either America or Great Britain. That nineteenth-century assessment independently reinforces the modern Grand Encampment chronology.

10.3 The modern three-Order Commandery sequence should not be projected backward unchanged

Modern American Commandery works the Order of the Red Cross, Order of Malta, and Order of the Temple. These did not necessarily originate simultaneously as one standardized system. Early degrees circulated as detached or side degrees and could be conferred within lodges, chapters, military lodges, or early encampment-like bodies before dedicated Templar governance was standardized.

11. Masonic Scholarship and Research Bodies

11.1 Society of Blue Friars and major Masonic scholars

Scholar	Blue Friars status	Relevant work	Finding
Arthur Edward Waite	Blue Friar No. 8 (1938)	The Templar Orders in Freemasonry	Examined Templar perpetuation legends in detail; found no documentary basis for medieval Templars secretly surviving as Freemasons; distinguished spiritual/symbolic descent from

Scholar	Blue Friars status	Relevant work	Finding
			literal institutional descent.
Wallace McLeod	Blue Friar; later Grand Abbot	Review of Born in Blood; ritual research	Rejected the Templar-to-Freemasonry thesis as inadequately supported and favored the documented evolutionary model from operative Masonry.
John Hamill	Blue Friar	Masonic historical works; UGLE scholarship	Treats direct medieval Templar descent of Freemasonry as a longstanding but discarded theory.
Henry Wilson Coil	Major Masonic historian	Freemasonry Through Six Centuries; Coil's Masonic Encyclopedia	Lists Templar descent among speculative origin theories and insists on evidence rather than analogy or legend.
S. Brent Morris	Blue Friar; former Grand Abbot	Scottish Rite Research Society scholarship	Treats high-degree Masonry as an eighteenth-century development rather than medieval survival.
Arturo de Hoyos	Blue Friar; Grand Abbot	Ritual historian, Grand Archivist/Grand Historian	States that there is no historical evidence connecting Freemasonry to the historical Knights Templar; ritual material is tradition and symbolic borrowing, not proof of descent.
Alain Bernheim	Blue Friar	Documentary history of eighteenth-century Masonry	Emphasizes traceable eighteenth-century development of high degrees and documentary method rather than legendary ancient succession.

11.2 Core principle emerging from Masonic scholarship

Ritual borrowing does not equal institutional descent.

- Some individual medieval Templars survived suppression: historically uncontroversial.
- Survivors entering secular life or other religious institutions does not prove continuation of the Order.
- No documentary chain has been established showing systematic Templar infiltration of operative mason guilds.
- No documentary chain has been established showing operative guilds becoming repositories of a secret Templar corporation.
- Eighteenth-century Masonry demonstrably developed Templar-themed and chivalric degrees.
- Masonic Templary can honor medieval Templars symbolically without claiming literal corporate succession.

11.3 Quatuor Coronati Lodge No. 2076

Quatuor Coronati is central to the evidence-based “authentic school” of Masonic historical research. Its Ars Quatuor Coronatorum and cumulative indexes identify substantial studies of the Strict Observance and eighteenth-century Templar Masonry, including work by Jacques Litvine and Alain Bernheim. The QC material places the Strict Observance broadly in the early 1750s through the Convent of Wilhelmsbad era and supports a mid-eighteenth-century rather than medieval origin for organized Masonic Templar systems.

11.4 Scottish Rite Research Society / Ancient and Accepted Scottish Rite

The Scottish Rite Research Society publishes Heredom and The Plumblin. Research on Kadosh and early high degrees shows that the Kadosh tradition is preserved in eighteenth-century high-degree manuscripts, including the Francken tradition. Older attributions sometimes place a Kadosh form in France around 1743, but that date should be graded as traditional unless supported by a contemporaneous ritual or minute. By the later 1750s and 1760s, the high-degree environment is much better documented.

11.5 Grand College of Rites

The Grand College of Rites preserves defunct and inactive Masonic rites through Collectanea. Its value is ritual genealogy: Knight of the Sword, Knight of the East, Knight Kadosh, Knight of the Temple, Memphis and other systems can be studied as distinct degrees rather than casually conflated under the single label “Templar.”

11.6 Allied Masonic Degrees

The Allied Masonic Degrees tradition demonstrates how detached or side degrees could circulate before centralized governance. Its research periodical Miscellanea was authorized in 1933 for papers of lasting Masonic interest. This history helps explain why early Templar degrees may appear in lodge, chapter, military-lodge, or detached-degree contexts before the rise of dedicated Commanderies and Great Priories.

11.7 Masonic periodicals and digital archives

Historic Masonic periodicals provide important contemporary or near-contemporary checks. Nineteenth-century Masonic writers were already skeptical of literal medieval ritual continuity and described the English Templar ritual as modern in language and arrangement. Periodicals also preserve the 1769 Boston chronology and nineteenth-century assessments that it was the earliest then-discovered Anglo-American Templar conferral.

Digital repositories included in this project include Masonic Periodicals Online, Internet Archive, Google Books, HathiTrust where accessible, Issuu, institutional PDF archives, The Skirret, Phoenixmasonry, and regional research-lodge websites. Issuu and other scan repositories are especially useful for locating proceedings, lodge histories, commemorative booklets, and older periodicals, but their scans should be checked against institutional or bibliographic metadata whenever possible.

12. Research Source Hierarchy and Evidence Grades

Tier	Source type	Examples / use
Tier 1	Primary documentary sources	Papal bulls, medieval trial records, legal registrations, incorporation records, minute books, warrants, manuscript rituals, contemporary proceedings.
Tier 2	Specialist scholarly research	Cambridge/academic medieval scholarship; Ars Quatuor Coronatorum; Heredom; The Plumblin; Collectanea; Miscellanea; Society of Blue Friars authors; recognized research-lodge transactions.
Tier 3	Historic periodicals and archival reproductions	Masonic Periodicals Online, Internet Archive, Google Books, HathiTrust, Issuu, university collections, digitized historic magazines.
Tier 4	Interpretive repositories	The Skirret, Phoenixmasonry, lodge research sites, private scans. Useful but to be checked against stronger evidence where possible.
Tier 5	Organizational self-description	Official websites, statutes, lineage claims, ceremonial histories. Authoritative for what the organization claims about itself, not automatically for medieval history.

12.1 Evidence grades used in the Masonic chronology

Grade	Meaning
A+	Direct surviving institutional record with repeated independent confirmation
A	Documented primary or exceptionally strong institutional/archival evidence
A-/B+	Well-supported by specialist scholarship but not always preserved as a single simple conferral record
B	Strong specialist secondary evidence
C	Traditional or retrospective attribution requiring caution

13. Claims, Myths, and Points Requiring Caution

Claim	Research conclusion
"The Vatican restored the Knights Templar in 2007."	False. The 2007 event was archival publication of Processus contra Templarios, not canonical restoration.
"The Chinon Parchment legally recognizes a modern successor."	False. Chinon concerns senior leaders in 1308 and does not identify a modern successor.
"Clement V found every Templar innocent of every charge."	Too broad. Senior leaders were absolved/reconciled; the broader investigation continued.
"The Order was never dissolved because it was not convicted of heresy."	Incorrect. Vox in excelso suppressed the Order in 1312 even though the mechanism was not a simple completed corporate heresy conviction.
"Freemasonry says fugitive Templars infiltrated operative guilds and became Freemasons."	Not an official position of the Grand Encampment and not supported by mainstream documentary Masonic scholarship.
"All modern Templar groups are the same."	False. They include Masonic bodies, Catholic restorations, ecumenical neo-Templar orders, esoteric organizations, independent Christian groups, and direct-succession claimants.
"A modern corporation's medieval founding date is its legal incorporation date."	False. Claimed lineage and legal formation must be recorded separately.
"A lawsuit proves succession."	False. Litigation proves that a claimant asserted a legal theory, not that the underlying medieval succession is true.
"A Vatican volunteer agreement restores Templar sovereignty."	False. Templari Oggi's Jubilee service agreement evidences Catholic institutional cooperation, not medieval juridical restoration.

14. Consolidated Master Timeline

Date	Event
1095	Pope Urban II calls the First Crusade at Clermont; he does not found the Templars.
1096-1099	First Crusade; Jerusalem captured 15 July 1099 and Latin Christian states established.
c.1119	Historical Templar fraternity founded in Jerusalem by Hugues de Payns and companions with support from Baldwin II.
1120s	St. Bernard of Clairvaux becomes a major theological and ecclesiastical supporter of the emerging fraternity; he is neither founder nor Templar.
January 1129	Council of Troyes, under Pope Honorius II through papal legate Matthew of Albano, formally recognizes the Order;

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Date	Event
	Bernard strongly influences the religious ideals surrounding the Latin Rule.
Early 1130s	Bernard writes In Praise of the New Knighthood, giving a major theological defense of the Templar vocation.
29 Mar. 1139	Pope Innocent II issues Omne Datum Optimum, granting direct papal protection and extensive privileges.
1144	Milites Templi.
1145	Militia Dei.
1187	Cresson, Hattin, and fall of Jerusalem.
1291	Fall of Acre; Templar operations center shifts principally to Cyprus.
13 Oct. 1307	Mass arrests in France.
17-20 Aug. 1308	Chinon: senior leaders examined, absolved from ecclesiastical censures, and reconciled.
22 Mar. 1312	Vox in excelso suppresses the Order.
2 May 1312	Ad providam transfers much former property to the Hospitallers.
18 Mar. 1314	Jacques de Molay and Geoffroi de Charney executed.
1737	Ramsay's Oration supplies influential chivalric/crusading Masonic rhetoric.
c.1743	Traditional early Kadosh attribution; documentation uncertain.
c.1750-1751	Early Templar-themed Masonic degrees and Strict Observance emerge on the Continent.
1758-1760s	Kadosh and other chivalric high degrees become increasingly documented.
28 Aug. 1769	William Davis receives Knight Templar in Boston.
11 Dec. 1769	Paul Revere receives Knight Templar.
14 May 1770	Joseph Warren receives Knight Templar.
1782	Convent of Wilhelmsbad marks rejection/reform of stronger literal Templar-origin claims in the Strict Observance environment.
1791	English Grand Conclave organized.
1804	Fabré-Palaprat modern Ordre du Temple revival in Paris.
1811	Great Priory / Royal Grand Conclave of Scotland development.
1816	Grand Encampment, Knights Templar, U.S.A. formed in New York.

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Date	Event
1837	Irish Supreme Grand Encampment formed.
1855	Continuous Canadian Masonic Templar organization established; later Grand Priory and Sovereign Great Priory.
1872	Great Priory of Ireland replaces earlier Supreme Grand Encampment structure.
1932	Belgian OSMTJ registered in Brussels.
1940s	Sousa Fontes / Porto administration emerges.
1962	SMOTJ U.S. corporate charter.
1970	Zdrojewski split; Ordre Renove du Temple founded in French esoteric milieu.
1973	Guarino OSMTJ U.S. line established; Ordre des Veilleurs du Temple declared.
1979	Militia Templi founded; OIMT develops around the same period.
1984	Order of the Solar Temple formed.
1988	OSTI established; Militia Templi receives canonical recognition.
1995	OPCCTS claims early use/organizational emergence; OSMTH Atlantic split develops in 1995-96.
1999	Swiss OSMTH registered in Geneva.
2001	Barbara Frale identifies significance of Chinon archival record.
2007	Processus contra Templarios published.
2008	Spanish Templar-successor claimant litigation reported.
2011	OPCCTS Texas nonprofit legal formation.
2015	Knights Templar International Novus Ordo Militiae Ltd. incorporated in Northern Ireland.
2018	Reported Caleb Goeke reorganization / present Knights Templar of North America incarnation in Justin, Texas; not original OPCCTS legal founding.
2019	IRS-derived records reflect OPCCTS tax-exempt recognition around March.
2021	Templari Oggi APS founded.
2025	Templari Oggi serves Jubilee pilgrims under agreement with the Dicastery for Evangelization.

15. Summary

The historical Knights Templar were a medieval Catholic religious-military institution founded in the early twelfth century, recognized and privileged by the papacy, and suppressed in 1312. The Chinon Parchment confirms that Clement V's representatives absolved and reconciled senior Templar leaders in 1308, but Chinon does not erase the later suppression or identify any modern legal successor.

Modern Templar organizations therefore require separate analysis. The Fabré-Palaprat revival of 1804 is a key ancestor of much later OSMTH/OSMTJ neo-Templarism. Twentieth-century divisions produced Belgian, Porto/Sousa Fontes, Zdrojewski, SMOTJ, Swiss OSMTH, OSMTHU, and many other lines. Some groups explicitly disclaim direct medieval descent; others make stronger survival or juridical-succession claims. Those claims must be graded separately from legal incorporation records.

Masonic Templary belongs in its own category. It is a documented eighteenth-century and later Christian Masonic chivalric tradition. The strongest evidence reviewed places organized Continental Templar-themed Masonic systems in the 1750s and the earliest securely documented Anglo-American Knight Templar conferral in Boston on 28 August 1769. Masonic scholarship repeatedly distinguishes chivalric symbolism and ritual homage from literal institutional descent from the medieval Order.

The research also shows why organizational labels are insufficient. A group can be non-Masonic in current practice yet descend through a modern neo-Templar lineage influenced by Freemasons. A Catholic Templar-inspired association can enjoy real Church cooperation without becoming the restored medieval Order. A lawsuit can assert succession without proving it. A legal entity may be founded centuries after the lineage date it claims.

16. Conclusion

The strongest defensible conclusion is that the medieval Order of the Temple ended as a functioning juridical institution through the papal suppression of 1312. The Chinon Parchment corrects an oversimplified popular narrative of universal Templar heresy by documenting absolution and reconciliation of senior leaders, but it does not provide the missing legal bridge from the fourteenth century to a modern corporation.

No modern organization examined in this project has demonstrated juridical continuity from the medieval Knights Templar merely through Chinon or through an asserted list of secret Grand Masters. Modern bodies should therefore be described according to what can actually be documented: modern revival, derivative neo-Templar organization, independent Christian Templar association, Catholic restoration, Catholic Templar-inspired service association, esoteric neo-Templar body, direct-succession claimant, or Masonic Templary.

Masonic Templary is historically distinct from survivalist neo-Templar claims. Its development is documentable in the eighteenth century, and its purpose is chivalric, Christian, moral, educational, devotional, charitable, and fraternal within Freemasonry. The evidence reviewed from the Grand Encampment, Quatuor Coronati, the Scottish Rite Research Society, the Grand College of Rites, Allied

Masonic Degrees, the Society of Blue Friars, research lodges, and historic Masonic periodicals supports this distinction.

For future additions to the registry, the controlling method should remain simple: record the organization's self-description, then separately record the earliest independent legal document, the earliest contemporary ritual or organizational record, its actual institutional affiliations, and the quality of any evidence offered for continuity across 1312. This approach protects both medieval history and modern organizations from being misrepresented.

Appendix A. Organization Registry

Institution	Date	Place	Founder / leadership	Classification
Historical Order of the Temple	c.1119	Jerusalem	Hugues de Payns and companions	Historical medieval Order; suppressed 1312
Fabré-Palaprat Ordre du Temple	1804	Paris, France	Bernard-Raymond Fabré-Palaprat and associates	Modern revival; Masonic founding milieu
Belgian OSMTJ	19 Jan. 1932	Brussels, Belgium	Joseph Cleeremans; Gustave Jonckbloedt; Theodore Covias	Neo-Templar derivative
Sousa Fontes / Porto OSMTH	1940s	Portugal	Antonio Campello Pinto de Sousa Fontes	Neo-Templar derivative
SMOTJ-USA	29 Jun. 1962 charter	Newark, New Jersey	Corporate Grand Priory leadership; Crolian William Edelen early Grand Prior	Modern ecumenical neo-Templar
Zdrojewski OSMTJ	1970	France / international	Antoine Jozef Zdrojewski	Neo-Templar derivative
Guarino OSMTJ USA	15 Feb. 1973	United States	Philip A. Guarino	Neo-Templar derivative; founder formerly Catholic priest
Militia Templi	17 May 1979	Tuscany, Italy	Marcello Alberto Cristofani della Magione	Catholic restoration; rejects direct juridical descent
OIMT	c.1979	Rome / international	Dom Johannes Becker associated	Ecumenical federation; Catholic historical connection
Ordre Renove du Temple	1970	France	Raymond Bernard / Julien Origas	Esoteric neo-Templar
Ordre des Veilleurs du Temple	1973	France	Reported Lucien M.	Esoteric neo-Templar
Ordre Ressuscite du Temple	1974	France	Michel Carpenet	Esoteric neo-Templar
Cercle du Temple et du Saint-Graal	1975	France	Noel R.; Jean-Marie Parent	Esoteric neo-Templar
Fraternite Johannite pour la Resurgence Templiere	1978	France	Jean-Marie Parent and associates	Johannite/esoteric neo-Templar
Order of the Solar Temple	1984	Europe / Canada milieu	Joseph Di Mambro; Luc Jouret	Defunct extremist/cultic neo-Templar
OSTI	19 Feb. 1988	Paris, France	Raymond Bernard	Esoteric neo-Templar
Autonomous Grand Priory of Scotland	2009 Grand Priory	Scotland	George Stewart and founding knights	Independent Christian, explicitly non-Masonic
Swiss OSMTH	25 Oct. 1999 registration	Geneva, Switzerland	Participating Grand Priors; Joseph Esposito; Sir Roy Redgrave	Ecumenical neo-Templar; disclaims direct descent
OPCCTS / Knights Templar of North America	24 Jan. 2011 Texas corporation; earlier claimed use 1995	Texas, USA	Earlier corporate officers; Caleb Goeke associated with later 2018 incarnation	Non-Masonic current body; Porto/Sousa Fontes provenance
Knights Templar International Novus Ordo Militiae Ltd.	16 Jun. 2015	Northern Ireland	Marion Thomas; Bernadette Noeleen Muresan incorporation-day director	Independent modern neo-Templar
Templari Oggi APS	March 2021	Italy	Modern Catholic lay association	Catholic Templar-inspired service association

Institution	Date	Place	Founder / leadership	Classification
Order of the Temple of Solomon	Modern restoration claims c.2013; constitution 2015/16	International / USA-related	Modern leadership not independently resolved here	Claims direct continuation; not independently established
Association / Sovereign Order of the Temple of Christ	Modern	Spain	Modern claimant organization	Claims succession; pursued Vatican litigation
Grand Encampment KT USA	20-21 Jun. 1816	New York City	Webb, Fowle, Snow, Lowndes; DeWitt Clinton first GM	Masonic Templary
Great Priory England & Wales	1791	England	Thomas Dunckerley and constituent Encampments	Masonic Templary
Great Priory Scotland	1811	Scotland	Duke of Kent charter; Alexander Deuchar	Masonic Templary
Great Priory Ireland	1837 / 1872	Ireland	Duke of Leinster-era Supreme Grand Encampment	Masonic Templary
Sovereign Great Priory Canada	1855 / 1868 / 1884	Canada	W. J. B. MacLeod Moore	Masonic Templary

Appendix B. Source Corpus and Bibliography

The following source corpus was used or explicitly cross-referenced during the research conversation. URLs are provided for transparency. Organizational sites are authoritative for organizational self-description; they are not automatically authoritative for medieval history.

ID	Source	URL
S01	University of Reading - Malcolm Barber staff profile	https://www.reading.ac.uk/history/our-staff/malcolm-barber
S02	Cambridge University Press - The Trial of the Templars	https://www.cambridge.org/core/books/trial-of-the-templars/3CEF95FD22DD129F4B4BFE3A6D5074D8
S03	Cambridge excerpt / Omne Datum Optimum context	https://assets.cambridge.org/97805218/56393/excerpt/9780521856393_excerpt.pdf
S04	Vatican Apostolic Archive - Exemplaria Praetiosa / Processus contra Templarios	https://www.archivioapostolicovaticano.va/content/aav/it/attivita/ricerca-e-conservazione/progetti/edizioni-di-fonti/exemplaria-praetiosa.html
S05	CBS/AP report on Chinon and 2007 publication	https://www.cbsnews.com/news/knights-templar-absolved-700-years-late/
S06	Vatican / L'Osservatore Romano item on Frale and Chinon	https://www.vatican.va/news_services/or/or_quo/cultura/079q04a1.html
S07	OSMTH official site - About / legacy	https://www.osmth.org/
S08	OSMTH official - Templar legacy / modern order history	https://www.osmth.org/templar-legacy/modern-order-history
S09	OSMTJ official history/about	https://osmtj.net/history/
S10	OSMTJ official about/statutes	https://osmtj.net/about/

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ID	Source	URL
S11	OSMTJ Guarino site	https://www.osmtjtemplar.com/
S12	SMOTJ official Grand Priors	https://smotj.org/grand-priors/
S13	SMOTJ Manual of the Order	https://library.smotj.org/wp-content/uploads/2024/06/Manual-of-the-Order-v.-5.0-final.pdf
S14	Swiss OSMTH registry PDF	https://www.osmth.it/wp-content/uploads/2019/06/ch-660.1.972.999-4.pdf
S15	OSMTH Grand Priory UK history	https://www.osmthgpuk.org/history-of-gpuk
S16	Autonomous Grand Priory Scotland history	https://www.skt.org.uk/Grand%20Priory/grand_priory.html
S17	Autonomous Grand Priory Scotland membership / non-Masonic statement	https://www.skt.org.uk/Membership/membership.html
S18	Knights Templar International Companies House NI631938	https://find-and-update.company-information.service.gov.uk/company/NI631938
S19	Militia Templi origin	https://militiatempli.uk/origin/
S20	Militia Templi restoration statement	https://www.ordo-militiae-templi.org/militia/en/restoration/
S21	Templari Oggi / Templars Today	https://www.templarstoday.us/
S22	EWTN - Templars Today Jubilee service	https://www.ewtnnews.com/vatican/reimagined-templar-knights-provide-assistance-to-2025-jubilee-pilgrims
S23	Knights Templar of North America / OPCCTS	https://www.knighttemplar.org/
S24	OPCCTS about	https://www.knighttemplar.org/about-us
S25	OPCCTS membership / non-Masonic statement	https://www.knighttemplar.org/membership
S26	OPCCTS business record aggregation	https://bizstanding.com/p/ordo%2Bpauperum%2Bcommilitum%2Bchristi%2Bet%2Btempli%2BSolomon-180699378
S27	OPCCTS trademark - Justia	https://trademarks.justia.com/869/06/ordo-pauperum-commilitum-christi-et-templi-solomonis-equites-86906595.html
S28	OPCCTS tax-exempt database	https://www.taxexemptworld.com/organizations/johnson-city-tx-texas.asp
S29	Older OPCCTS historical document mirror	https://studyres.com/doc/7892208/about-chivalric-orders-and-the-knights-templar
S30	Grand Encampment KT USA - Mission	https://usagekt.org/mission/
S31	Grand Encampment KT USA - Heritage	https://usagekt.org/heritage/
S32	Grand Encampment KT USA - Founders	https://usagekt.org/founders/
S33	Grand Encampment KT USA - Educational Foundation	https://usagekt.org/kteduf/
S34	Great Priory of Scotland official	https://greatprioryofscotland.co.uk/
S35	Great Priory of Ireland official history	https://freemason.ie/about-grand-lodge/appendant-bodies/great-priory-of-ireland/
S36	Sovereign Great Priory of Canada history	https://sovereigngreatprioryofcanada.ca/history/
S37	Great Priory of Queensland history	https://www.knightstemplar.org.au/history/

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ID	Source	URL
S38	Quatuor Coronati official site	https://www.quatuorcoronati.com/
S39	Quatuor Coronati AQC cumulative index	https://www.quatuorcoronati.com/wp-content/uploads/2022/02/AQC-Index-Volumes-1-to-134.pdf
S40	Scottish Rite Research Society publications	https://scottishrite.org/media-publications/publications-srrs/
S41	Heredom ritual-history paper	https://scottishrite.org/wp-content/uploads/2010/12/heredom_v17_rituals.pdf
S42	Heredom cumulative index	https://scottishrite.org/wp-content/uploads/2010/12/heredom_index1-17.pdf
S43	Grand College of Rites	https://grandcollegeofrites.org/
S44	Grand College of Rites - Collectanea	https://grandcollegeofrites.org/collectanea/
S45	Allied Masonic Degrees USA history	https://amdusa.org/wp/history/
S46	The Skirret - Waite, Templar Orders in Freemasonry	https://skirret.com/papers/waite/the_templar_orders_in_freemasonry.html
S47	The Skirret - Traditional Degrees	https://skirret.com/papers/traditional_degrees.html
S48	Society of Blue Friars regulations	https://thesocietyofbluefriars.org/regulations/
S49	Wallace McLeod review of Born in Blood	https://www.freemasonry.bcy.ca/texts/reviews/born_in_blood02.html
S50	Masonic Periodicals Online - 1891 Freemason's Chronicle issue	https://masonicperiodicals.com/static/media/periodicals/119-FCN-1891-10-17-001-SINGLE.pdf
S51	Masonic Periodicals Online - 1878 issue discussing American KT	https://masonicperiodicals.com/static/media/periodicals/119-MMG-1878-10-01-001-SINGLE.pdf
S52	Masonic Periodicals Online - 1863 discussion of Templar ritual	https://masonicperiodicals.com/periodicals/mmr/issues/mmr_07111863/page/9/
S53	Research Lodge paper - Templar suppression / origin theory	https://www.researchlodge.org/Papers/Details?rowKey=The+Albigensian+Crusade+-+Precursor+Of+The+Templar+Suppression.pdf
S54	Texas York Rite / Commandery history	https://yorkritetexas.org/commandery/our-history/
S55	Massachusetts York Rite history	https://www.mayorkrite.org/grand-commandery?catid=15&id=75%3Acommandery-history&view=article
S56	Order of the Temple of Solomon - legal/status claims	https://members.knightstemplarorder.org/Legal-Tax-Status
S57	Order of the Temple of Solomon - government / constitution claims	https://knightstemplarorder.org/government/templar-government/
S58	History News Network - Spanish Templar claimant lawsuit	https://www.historynewsnetwork.org/article/knights-templar-heirs-sue-vatican
S59	Pappers Belgium - Ordre du Temple de Jerusalem corporate record	https://www.pappers.be/fr/company/ordre-du-temple-de-jerusalem-0801.525.945
S60	OSMTJ 1804 site	https://www.osmtj1804.org/

Additional repositories searched or designated for future source expansion include Issuu, Internet Archive, HathiTrust, Google Books, Masonic Periodicals Online, institutional proceedings archives, lodge and research-lodge digital collections, and historic Masonic magazines. When a scan lacks reliable metadata, it should be treated as a lead until bibliographic details are independently confirmed.

Research note: This report distinguishes historical fact, legal record, institutional self-description, and disputed lineage claim. It should not be read as recognition of any modern body as the legal successor of the medieval Knights Templar unless such recognition is explicitly established by competent historical or legal evidence.